

Hearing God's Voice

In this study from Luke 14, we have been studying this principle: if a man will humble himself, he shall be exalted. We found out that, ultimately, the greatest act of humility is to choose what Jesus has done for you unconditionally in redemption.

Jesus said:

If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.

Then He went on to say:

Which of you, intending to build a tower, sitteth not down first, and counteth the cost, whether he have sufficient to finish it? Lest haply, after he hath laid the foundation, and is not able to finish it, all that behold it begin to mock him, Saying, This man began to build, and was not able to finish.

What He was saying is that the only thing in this life that will guarantee you the building material to finish your tower is an unconditional choosing of Jesus.

When He said, "If any man comes to Me and hates not," we know He was not talking about a violent, "I am going to hell because I hate you" kind of hate. He was talking about a violent, vehement, unconditional decision for Jesus over everything else that exists. Only then can He guarantee you the building materials to finish your tower.

That includes the reconstruction of your family if it has fallen apart. That includes your businesses. That includes your call and your ministries. You are not losing your houses, lands, and wife. He is guaranteeing you the building materials to finish your tower.

Then He went on into the wisdom of God:

What king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand? Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth an ambassage, and desireth conditions of peace.

The king with ten thousand takes stock of the situation. Can he whip the one with twenty thousand, or should he send an ambassador? In either case, a confrontation is coming. While the other king is still a great way off, this man does not have the luxury of making no decision. The king with twenty thousand is marching on him. He has to decide what to do.

When Jesus is teaching on the exaltation that comes from God alone in Luke 14, He is saying that if you do not choose Jesus, you will not have the counsel. You will have no one to consult with in the many facets of life that demand decisions of this caliber. You will not have the wisdom to know whether to send an ambassador or take stock in your stores and know whether you can, with ten thousand, go make war and defeat twenty thousand.

From there we went into the voice of God and began to study His voice, because this wisdom and counsel available to a man who chooses Jesus unconditionally is the kind of wisdom and counsel needed in this life to put you over.

Many men and women fall short of fulfilling their ministries. They fall short of fulfilling businesses, if God has called them to place their business between hell and people trying to get there. They do not have counsel and wisdom available because they did not have what it took to choose Jesus unconditionally. They shut the doors to the kind of wisdom He has available and never learned to differentiate between the operation of the spirit and the soul, the emotional realm. Consequently, they are continually led off by the flesh and fail.

But for the man or woman, such as yourself, who chooses Jesus unconditionally, what we are opening from the Word of God is to show you what is available.

You are not going to come here and sit every Friday night in prayer and every Sunday morning under the Word, and then come Friday night and operate out of your spirit for an hour or two, and remain unchanged in respect to which realm you are operating out of: the soulish emotional realm or that rock-solid, ironclad, steadfast place of the spirit.

The quicker you learn to differentiate which one you are operating out of, the quicker you are going to begin to succeed in this life because of God's exaltation. There is not a thing this side of hell the devil can do about it. And I mean geographically, of course. I was not cursing. Geographically, this side of hell.

Look again at Luke 16:22:

And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom: the rich man also died, and was buried.

Notice this: the body of the rich man was buried, but his inner man, his spirit man, in hell lifted up his eyes, being in torments, and saw Abraham afar off and Lazarus in his bosom.

He cried and said:

Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water, and cool my tongue; for I am tormented in this flame.

The reason most people have trouble differentiating between spirit and soul, though we do not have as much trouble differentiating body, is that we do not understand we are eternal creatures whether we like it or not.

Every person ever born to a man and woman is living today. Nobody has perished. I do not care what generation or century they lived in. Nobody has perished. Whether they exist in hell or on the planet heaven, no one has perished. Everyone is alive.

Notice, the rich man's body was buried, and in hell he lifted up his eyes. If there was any area more confusing to me, it was the operation of spirit, soul, and body. I found out it was confusing to me because it was confusing to the teachers who were teaching me.

It is difficult to differentiate: when am I operating out of the spirit, and when am I operating out of the soul? When God began to open up the study of the anatomy of spirit, soul, and body, it started setting me free.

This man's body was buried in the ground, yet his inner man, his spirit man, in hell lifted up his eyes. Notice, the emotions were with him in hell, because torment is an emotion.

The hidden man of the heart, the inner man, has eyes. If he has eyes, he has hands. Lazarus, in Abraham's bosom, was asked to dip the tip of his finger in water. So we know that people in heaven at least have the tips of fingers. The man in hell wanted that fingertip to come with a drop of water for his tongue, because he had emotional torment in those flames.

So we know the spiritual anatomy of the inner man has hands, eyes, and a tongue. If he has hands, eyes, and a tongue, then the inner man also has a spiritual brain. That spiritual brain fits in your physical brain.

When God talks to you, He does not communicate with some area around the belly button.

When I used to see preachers operate in a word of knowledge, they would walk up and tell someone, "You have this in your body," or "You have this wrong." I wanted to know how they did that. I did not know it was the call of God on my life to fill a particular kind of ministry. I thought everybody ranted and raved and craved to know how that man knew something was wrong in someone's body and could define it.

William Branham had a true gift as a prophet of God. If you did not get healed in the first five statements, he would go on and tell you your doctor's name and your case history right down the line. He had a genuine gift. Of course, there are phonies in the land, but he had a genuine gift. Any prominent man of God will tell you that today.

For me to sit there and watch somebody move like that, to walk up to somebody and say, "You have a valve in your heart that is going haywire," I could not understand how everybody would not want to know the voice of God to that degree.

So every preacher I could catch, I would say, "How did you hear God's voice? How did He tell you about that person? How does He talk to you?" I would pester them until they threw me out. I followed one man to the trailer he was staying in. They almost had to get rude with me to make me leave at two in the morning.

I would say, "How did you hear His voice?"

"Well, He spoke to my spirit."

That really helped me.

I said, "Thanks a lot for the help, but please identify the approximate region."

"Well, He spoke way down in my inner man."

They would reach somewhere around the center of their bosom.

I would say, "Would you please identify the approximate vicinity? The belly button area? A little higher?"

I wanted to know.

"Well, He just spoke to my spirit."

"Where?"

"Way down deep in my spirit."

The same man told me he had a vision of the human spirit, and it looked like a little vial setting crossways with two tubes, one feeding something in and one taking it out. He said, "That is the human spirit."

Is it not incredible what we get into our minds?

The baptism of the Holy Spirit is actually resident in the inner workings of your spirit. The reason His voice appears to come from way down in the center of your bosom is that, in the anatomy of inner man and outer man, you have a spiritual brain that operates through your physical brain. Your physical brain empowers your spiritual brain to operate in the natural world where you and I live.

When He speaks, the process of His speaking does not take place on the surface level where mental energy generates thought and language. He speaks in a different realm. He speaks to that spiritual mind on the inside of your physical brain. Because it is recessed in your physical brain, the appearance of it seems to come from way down in the center of your being.

In reality, it comes from the place where the Holy Spirit lives in the consciousness of the spirit man. It comes right up out of your spirit. The Holy Spirit lives in your consciousness, in your spiritual mind, and operates through your physical mind to make contact with the physical world.

This is what is interesting: you have spiritual eyes, and they fit in your physical eyes like a glove. If I were to step out of my body and my inner man were standing here, he would look just like me, only my defects would be gone. My God, I would be so handsome.

If God granted you a miracle to see me without a glorified body, and I held up my finger, what would my finger be made of? If it were my physical finger, you would say it was made of electrons, protons, neutrons, atoms, molecules, the basic structure of matter.

How about my spiritual finger? It would be made of spirit.

People think spirit is some force that just floats around. Spirit is actually building material. It is a substance God uses to make His eternal creatures. If I held up my spiritual finger and asked, "What is it made of?" you would finally have to say, "I guess it is made of spirit."

Yes. It is made of the building material of heaven, a spiritual substance. It would undoubtedly break down to molecules, atoms, and spiritual electrons, neutrons, and protons running around in my spirit body. Why? Because this natural earth is nothing more than a copy of the real, only it is made out of a different substance. Even that substance is nothing more than an expression of the real.

Hebrews says that the things which are seen were made from things which do not appear. This physical world is a birthed child from a spiritual realm. That is why physical law has to bow to spiritual law: spiritual law fathered physical law, and physical law is subject to it.

Glory to God.

So if my spiritual finger is made of spirit, so is my spiritual brain.

I met Ronald Coyne. He has popped that eye out so many times that his socket is getting big. Ronald Coyne is the plastic-eye miracle. Something happened that put his eye out, and they put a plastic eye in. I think he was about nine or ten years old.

I know him. I fronted for him in a meeting. Here is what he loves to do. He says, "Now you watch. You be the witness."

They taped his good eye so tight that there was no way he could see through it. Everybody checked it out. He could not see through it. Then he reached up and popped the other eye out. There was this plastic eye, and you cannot see through it. It will let light through, but you cannot see through it.

He held his eye open, and you could see the back of his socket. There was nothing in there. Then somebody gave him a driver's license, and he read the address and the name. He was reading it, and there was no eyeball in there. Then he popped the plastic eye back in, and you and I could not see through it, but he could. So he went on reading it.

As the years went by, I marveled over this miracle God had done. I started praying, "God, it is impossible that he could see. He did not have an eye."

The Lord said, "Oh yes, he did."

I said, "I looked up in there. There was no eye."

The Lord kept insisting that he had an eye.

I said, "He does not have an eye."

"But he does have an eye."

"He does not have an eye."

"But he does."

Then the Lord told me what He did. He said, "I granted him a miracle."

The discerning of spirits is a supernatural gift. Suddenly you are standing there, minding your own business, and that gift comes on you. Your eyes open and you see angels over there, angels over there, and demons camped just outside the praise area. They are holding your coat, waiting for you to come back out so you can get ugly again. They are in the parking lot waiting by your cars: "Can I park your car for you?" People feel real nice in church and get back out there and turn ugly again.

Through discerning of spirits, you can see not only angels, but into the spiritual realm. It is a whole viable world. God grants a miracle and opens your eyes so you can look into the spirit world and see it at the same time as the physical world.

He told me about Ronald Coyne: "I did a miracle in reverse. I opened his spiritual eye to see into a physical world without the aid of an eyeball."

I thought, "My God, this man is walking around looking with his spirit eye. This is incredible." When he is glorified, he will get the eye that was put out reconstructed again.

There was a woman I knew who had all her eardrum removed, yet she had perfect pitch in that ear. She could hear better than anybody else, because He opened her spiritual eardrum to hear audible sounds on the sound wave we live on. The doctors were baffled by it.

Every once in a while, one of these "believe it or not" institutions that expose frauds would challenge Ronald Coyne. They were going to expose this fraud taking people's money. The challenge would be issued, and that was the last you heard about it. They begged to get out of it.

That is a miracle. But do you know what I think would be a greater miracle? Cut some man's legs off, and God gives him spirit legs. He comes walking into the service, and you say, "Do not wear shorts anymore. You are messing our people up."

You have an inner man. He has an anatomy. One day we will get our glorified body, but meanwhile He gave you the baptism of the Holy Spirit to guide you into all truth and mortify you against the flesh.

God talks to the consciousness of the inner man, that spiritual mind that operates through the physical brain.

It is incredible that there are three or four ways He communicates with His children. We are going to reopen this and study the four ways, because we will refer again and again to the inner witness.

The inner witness is the absolute foundational operation of the Spirit by which He leads all His children. I do not care whether you are the mighty apostle, the mighty prophet, or anything else. The basic way He will lead you is through the inner witness.

God will tell me things in the Spirit about people, and I can hear His voice. He activates that gift all the time in public and private situations when I am ministering to people. But I can pray, "God, am I supposed to move or not?" and He does not come up to me and say, "Yes, you will move," and so forth. He leads me by the inner witness. He drops an inner witness in my lap and says, "Do what you want with it."

I think, "It sure would be nice if He led me by that other anointing." But He does not.

The foundational operation of the Spirit, the basis for your leadership, the foremost primary way He leads His children, is by the inner witness.

The second way He communicates is by revelation. That is when He capsules a revelation like a computer chip, and the Holy Spirit explodes that computer chip within your spirit. All of a sudden, in half a second, you can receive enough information to run your business for a year.

He capsules a revelation, sends it across to my spirit, and explodes it. Suddenly I understand enough to keep me busy preaching for three months, and He communicated that in half a second.

In meditation or during prayer, something will explode in your spirit, and you know how to solve the whole problem because He communicated information.

This is what makes your class of being different from any other class. God communicates with your spirit because you are a spiritual being, created in His class. That is why He prefers to communicate with your spirit. He could communicate with your physical mind, but He would have to slow down.

He would rather capsule up a revelation in one hundredth of a second, send it across, explode it, and you say, "Oh, I understand the whole thing." If you communicated it at your rate of communication, it would take you a month to say what you received in half a second. If He communicated with your mind, He would have to slow down: "Hello, child."

The third way He communicates with His children is by voice. He will actually speak an audible voice within your spirit. Most people do not operate in that level because they cannot differentiate between soul and spirit. They cannot sort out whether it is their thinking process or the Holy Spirit actually saying something within their spirit.

We will spend the most time differentiating in that area, because it also has to do with the inner witness. People cannot tell whether they had an emotional response or whether something was imparted that actually gave them an inner witness.

The fourth way He communicates is by vision. In my own personal experience, based on the Word of God, I have found that these visions usually come into operation in my life when the anointing is on me, generally pertaining to revelation knowledge from His Word or witnessing to somebody. He communicates information through a vision for their life.

I hardly ever see them unless the anointing is heavy on me. When you are witnessing and catch on fire, verses start coming, and people say, "What about this?" Suddenly you are pulling verses out that you did not even know you knew. That is the anointing, and under that kind of anointing He can impart visions.

He uses visions with me mostly when I am heavy under word of knowledge and word of wisdom. When I am looking at people, I may see their anatomy, organs, or things wrong. The other way He uses visions in my life is to communicate revelation knowledge.

God was trying to show me what Jesus meant when He said, "If your hand offends you, cut it off; if your eye offends you, pluck it out." He was showing me that this was talking about the flesh and the extremes we should go to in dealing with the flesh. Matthew 18 was about offending people.

I was meditating and meditating, but I could not quite correlate it in my spirit. I had been praying most of the night in tongues and meditating on the Word. I was lying there, rolling that whole chapter over in meditation, again and again.

All of a sudden a vision came. It was so quick that I blinked, saw it, and came out of it. It seemed like it had nothing to do with anything, but when I came out of it, instantly I knew the revelation in that chapter.

In the vision, I was speeding up a dirt road. I do not know whose car it was. It was an older car. Suddenly I ran off the road. The car tilted sideways, the door opened, and I fell out and rolled down the hill. I looked up and saw the car rolling down after me. It rolled over me, and the door, which had bent back on the first roll, pinned my hand underneath it.

I jerked on my hand and tried to get it out. Suddenly the engine caught on fire, and the flames were burning back toward the gas tank very fast. I was sitting there jerking on my hand, and I could not get it out.

Do not ask me where the knife came from. I think it just appeared in my hand, a great big long knife. I knew I had to make a decision: cut my hand off and save my life, or perish in the flames. Guess what decision I made.

I went ahead and cut around my hand to the bone. I remember it vividly. Then I jerked up hard and snapped the bone. I was running from the wreck down the hill, holding my arm like this, and the car exploded. The explosion propelled me through the air, and that is when I came out of the vision.

The Spirit was saying to me, "How many times are you in a situation like this, where it requires the literal cutting off of your hand?"

I said, "A person does not run into that situation very often."

He said, "That is right. I want you to view the flesh, unforgiveness, strife, and offending little ones with that same degree of magnitude. I want you, at any cost, to get those things out of your life."

He communicated that thing in a vision instantly, in half a second. But that study will be farther down the road. Right now we have to major on the foundational gift, the inner witness.

Most of you cannot differentiate between the soul realm and its emotions, and when He is actually imparting the go-ahead in your spirit on business deals, living, life, or anything else. There are times when He will instill that check that says, "Do not do it."

You met somebody, and He cautioned you. You said, "But look at them. They are the perfect Christian," and you entered into a deal with them. They took you to the cleaners. Later you remembered, "That is what that was. Something went off inside me that said, 'Do not do it.'" You overrode it and paid the consequences.

At the time you were saying, "Is it or is it not?" The circumstances overwhelmed the inner witness in you because you did not know how to discern whether it was God or not. You did not know whether you were operating out of emotions or that rock-solid, steadfast place that cannot steer you wrong: the spirit man and the inner witness.

How many have ever been in that situation? How many have ever made a business deal that took you to the cleaners, and later you remembered, "I knew it. I just had a feeling"?

Then why did you not go by it? Because you did not really know whether it was God or not. You knew afterward.

What I want to know is how some of you can be so slow learning your lesson.

Again, I exhort those of you praying in the Spirit. You made a quality decision that you are going to spend at least two or three hours a week operating out of your inner man. He who prays in the Spirit, or in an unknown tongue, is in the Spirit.

You deliberately, by an act of your will, put yourself into the Spirit and allow the Holy Spirit to actually flow through you for three hours out of the part of you where all these things we are talking about take place.

When you let Him flow through you and out of that inner man for two or three hours a week, it will not be long before you become familiar with where He creates His tongues within your consciousness. It is the same place He talks to you, the same place He imparts the inner witness, the same place He sends revelation knowledge across and explodes it.

The more you operate out of the consciousness of the inner man, where the Holy Ghost lives, by letting Him create that supernatural language of tongues and speak it out of your mouth, the more familiar you will become with the part of you where the leadership of the Holy Spirit takes place.

That makes me want to cancel the rest of this meeting and say, "We are going into prayer. Would you all excuse me?"

You may say, "Brother Roberson, I just cannot tell what is soul and what is spirit. He speaks to me, and I go do it. Then after I do it, I find out it was not Him. It destroys my confidence to know what is Him and what is not."

How many have ever sworn up and down, "God spoke to me," then gone and done it, and it was not Him? Me too. The Lord spoke to me, I went and did it, and it was not Him. It shakes a person's confidence.

You get to the place where you say, "If that was not Him, then I do not know what is." You cannot tell whether this is your emotions or whether He is actually dealing with you in the inner man.

Why do you think the devil fights tongues so hard? Number one, he wants to keep you in the fleshly soul realm so he can be the one who leads you around messing churches up and projecting God to unbelievers as something nobody wants to have. He wants you to keep splitting churches. He does not want you ever to come to a place where you can operate out of your spirit.

There is only one real way you can get there: familiarize yourself with the Holy Spirit, the person who is doing the communicating with you. If He brought a prayer language with Him and wants to pray through you, do you think that might have something to do with enhancing you in the part of you where you hear Him?

It will not be long before you start differentiating. You will say, "I know that is God."

"How do you know?"

"Because I am familiar with His operation."

The first foundation of this leadership is the Word. This is what Jesus was talking about: if any man comes to Me and does not violently, vehemently, emphatically choose Me and My Word, he will not have the counsel to know what to do.

All leadership of the Spirit is based first on the foundational rock of the Word of God. He will not lead you contrary to the Word. The Spirit and the Word agree.

Go to Romans 8. We will begin with verse 13 and differentiate between spirit and soul.

Whenever I heard spirit, soul, and body teachers, they always put three circles or three triangles on a blackboard. They would say, "This is your spirit," and outline the characteristics of the spirit. Then they would say, "This is your soul," and outline the characteristics of the soul. Then, "This is your body," and outline the characteristics of the body.

In my relentless endeavor to find out how the voice of God worked, I would say, "Now tell me once again, what do you classify as the soul realm, and what do you classify as the spirit realm?"

The man in hell had torments, and that means your soul goes with you when you go, whether you go to hell or heaven. Your soul accompanies you. So this makes it interesting. The soul consists of emotions, will, and intellect.

My question to God was, "What is the difference between my human soul and the soul of, say, a horse or a dog? If my soul is my mind, my will, my intellect, and my emotional faculties, then what is the difference?"

We have some dogs that think they are human. The reason they classify a dog as man's best friend is because you can treat them mean, yell at them, then say, "Come here," and the dog comes back. It seems like they have a little spirit because they love you.

No, they love you, but according to the popular teachers in the land, when your little dog goes to doggy heaven, it is not the same one you go to. There are animals in heaven, but they come into existence there.

When you hold a little dog up and it looks at you, it seems like it has a little spirit. It can do everything but talk to you. So I said, "What is the difference between my soul and the soul of a dog?"

When God created your intellect, what in the world did it look like? When He held your intellect in His hand and said, "This is the part of My creation," what did it look like? How about when He created your emotions and held them in His hands? What did they look like? When He created your willpower and held it in His hand, what did it look like?

The difference between you and a dog is that when He created your mind, will, emotions, and intellect, He deposited them in an eternal substance called spirit. When He put your mind, will, and intellect as forces into your spirit, He gave them their eternity, because spirit is the substance God uses to build His eternal creatures. That is what angels are made of.

With a dog, the emotions are a soul, but it is a fleshly soul. It is not deposited in an eternal substance called spirit. When the little dog lays down and ceases to exist, its soul perishes with it. The difference is that yours is deposited in an eternal substance called spirit. In doing so, He gave your soul its eternity.

On one end of the spectrum, my soul is connected to my spirit, and my spirit operates through my soul. On the other end of the spectrum, just as a dog has forces in its body called a fleshly soul, my flesh is capable of housing the other end of the spectrum, which is my soul.

If I went to heaven at this moment and stepped out of my body, the resistance against my soul would be gone. The part of me that had death working in it, the part that operated like a fleshly soul and influenced my soul, would be dead. All that influence would be gone. I would go on to heaven with no temptations, nothing derogatory, and nothing from the flesh, because the flesh would be forced to turn loose of its influence on my soul.

The problem is that we want to operate on the other end of the spectrum, the part of the soul the spirit operates through before it gets to the body. We do not want to operate on the fleshly end of the spectrum, through the intellect and emotions of the soul that go the other direction and try to overpower your spirit.

To walk in the Spirit is to come to a place in your spirit man where you activate the soul, and it goes in the reverse direction and overpowers the flesh. This is what Paul is talking about when he says:

 This I say then, Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

The problem is that differentiating between the spirit operation of the soul and the fleshly operation of the soul is very close. It is hard to tell the difference because of the range of emotions the soul has.

The soul has the ability to soar like an eagle. If a man walks after the flesh, this usually happens according to circumstances:

"Everything is going my way. I got a raise. They doubled my salary. I got a new car. They gave me a lifetime job with benefits."

Everything is going your way, and it causes an emotional high. You are riding on top of the ladder. But the soul has the capacity to go as low as it can go high.

Most of us do not have trouble differentiating between the emotional lows of the soul and the operation of the Spirit. When you feel defeated, depressed, beat up, do not care, and do not want to go to church, you know the Holy Ghost did not lead you into that.

Where most of us mess up is the other end of the spectrum, the emotional high:

"I am so high. Things are going so good. This has to be God. Glory to God. He has opened all these doors. He is moving for me."

It may not be God at all. It could be the other end of the soul's operation. If it is, it will pull you off into something that is not God, just as the emotional lows will force you off into something that is not God. If either one is not God, the devil will get you where he wants you.

It is easy to differentiate the lows. It is hard to differentiate the highs. This is where you must develop the inner man and learn where His voice and inner witness come from. The foundation begins with the Word of God.

Look at where He is leading most of you now. You may say, "God led me to do this great work in Oklahoma City." Then you get up there, cause a big mess, and come back beat up.

Do not tell me God led you over there. You were not ready to be led over there. The only place He is leading you at this point is out of a walk based on the flesh and into a walk of the Spirit. If you are still walking in so much flesh that the devil can corral you, beat you up, and cause you to fail, I

guarantee God did not lead you over there.

He is majoring on another kind of leadership in your life: out of a walk where you are dominated by emotions and into an operation of peace where you know where His voice is coming from.

Romans 8:13 says:

For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live. For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.

The translation of these two verses together is this: if you live after, or walk after, the carnal desires and dictates of the flesh, you will die. But as many as accept the leadership of the Spirit, He leads into a walk of sonship, which speaks of maturity, a grown-up place in God.

Even though you are wearing a physical flesh body and have the emotional realm of the soul with its highs and lows, even though the flesh wants to lust, sin, and do everything else the flesh is famous for, He says that as many as accept the leadership of the Spirit are first and foremost led into a walk of sonship and maturity. That is a place in God where the dictates of the flesh do not dominate, lead, corral, or defeat you, but where the inner man rules over the flesh.

First and foremost, this is where He is leading you: out of a walk where your emotions, depressions, impassés, ups one day and downs the next, dominate you.

If God led you to do a mighty work and you get over there with a genuine gift flowing, that is not the question. God uses me. We are not questioning that. When I lay hands on the sick, they recover. We are not questioning that either.

But if you say He led you to do this work, and the devil corrals you, defeats you, and brings reproach on the kingdom because you were not ready, I can guarantee that the only leadership He is emphasizing in your life is out of a walk where the flesh dominates and into a walk of maturity where it does not.

Most of us get trapped, not by the depression end, but by the glory end. You may be no more ready to run out and invoke that kind of pressure on your life. But because you have an extreme talent, or are very good in a certain area, you can be sucked off by the operation of the flesh.

Elvis Presley could have been born again one day and drawn more people than Jimmy Swaggart because he was Elvis Presley. If he had said, "I am going to sing for Jesus," stadiums would have packed out because of what he was capable of. But that would not mean God sent him.

It would not be long before the devil came in from four different directions and corralled and defeated him because of the entry he had through the emotions of the flesh to overpower the operation of the spirit.

How do you define the difference? Do I like emotional highs? Yes. I like to run around, jump up and down, scream praise God, and have the greatest time in the whole world. Emotions were given to enjoy life with. I love happiness and joy. I like to run around ecstatic, on top, saying, "I feel so good. Glory, I feel good." Do you think I want to run around saying, "I feel bad, I feel bad"?

I have found out that even joy is a sustaining foundation that gives you the substance you need to stand patiently through a trial. That is what joy is for. He said, "Count it joy."

I love emotional highs. I love to run around in them. But I also know the operation of the Spirit. I do not like emotional lows. The further I get into the Spirit, the more I dictate to them, the less control they have over my life, and the more I release the constant presence of joy and happiness, because I love it.

A teacher is supposed to feed your spirit man and teach you how to operate out of him. An evangelist who preaches to the lost preaches to the soul realm, and the emotions are designed to hook a ring in with a chain and lead you by that chain: lead you to the altar, lead you into a healing line.

But the teacher is supposed to teach the spirit how to receive from God. There is a difference.

What is the difference between the anointing in a singer and skill or talent? When a person has the substance of the Spirit and the Holy Ghost, and their life is sold out, they begin to sing a song and it reaches past the emotional realm. It reaches down on the inside. Because the Holy Ghost is causing an anointing in them, it causes an anointing in you. The song goes farther than the world can take it. It takes you past the emotional realm and invokes worship, until God comes and starts camping with your spirit, and you get caught up into a heavenly place with Him.

There is a big difference.

One of these days, as God keeps unfolding your walk of the Spirit, we are going to have worship. Right now, your priority is not who gets what, who gets to sing here or there. Your priority is the leadership of the Spirit. He leads you out of a walk dominated by flesh and into that walk of the Spirit.

Let me show you how to differentiate between the two, so you can identify the steadfastness of the inner man.

Romans 8:13-15 says:

For if ye live after the flesh, ye shall die: but if ye through the Spirit do mortify the deeds of the body, ye shall live. For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God. For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.

When I cry, "Abba, Father," what is going on?

Verse 16 says:

The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God.

So, in this inner witness, when He bears witness, He causes us to cry, "Abba, Father."

We have a scriptural foundational fact: the Holy Spirit within your human spirit will bear witness. But Paul says we have not received the spirit of bondage and fear. That mess did not come from God. That kingdom exists with the flesh and the devil's realm.

It does not matter who tells you disease came from God or teaches you poverty came from God. He says we did not receive bondage and fear from God.

What we received is the Spirit bearing witness with our spirit, causing us to cry, "Abba, Father." But we do not walk around hearing a little voice inside our spirit saying, "Abba, Father. Abba, Father." It is an expression: I am yielding to You because You are the Father of my spirit.

No matter how bad the bondage, fear, corruption, pressure from the flesh, cares of this world, or deceitfulness of riches gets, no matter how ungodly the pressure becomes until you are a bundle of nerves ready to collapse, that did not come from God. This is the part that came from God: the part crying, "Abba, Father."

The way He cries "Abba" is underneath the corruption. He bears witness that says, "I do not care how bad it is. You are the Father of my spirit. I am not moved by what I see or feel. I am only moved by what I believe."

So in differentiating between the emotional highs and lows of the soul and that rock-steadfast voice of the inner witness, first understand this: as He leads you out of bondage, corruption, and flesh into a walk of maturity, the inner witness is designed to lead you out of the bondage and corruption of the flesh into liberty and maturity. Not where the soul leads you through emotions, but where the spirit leads.

Now I can help you identify the operation of your spirit.

How many of you have ever come to a time in your Christian walk when the pressure became intolerable? It became so heavy with bondage, fear, depression, and trial that you felt forsaken by God and everybody. You even felt like you wanted to give up, and some of you tried.

Even though you tried back then to give up, notice that you are here now. Why do you think you are here?

Because the soul realm, which fluctuates from emotional highs of ecstatic joy and happiness to emotional lows of depression, can only operate so low. Then it runs into the foundation, the rock of the spirit. In that operation, the part of you that would not turn loose was below, or above, the operation of bondage and fear. That was your spirit. That is where the Holy Ghost dwells.

Even though it got so heavy that you tried to give up, something on the inside kept crying, "Abba, Father. You are the Father of my spirit." It kept crying out continually and protesting. You could not lie down on the bed in your sunk, "I want to give up" state, because something inside would not let you turn loose.

You tried to turn loose:

"I want to quit. Leave me alone."

But it kept crying, "Abba. You are the Father of my spirit."

The part of you that refused to completely turn loose is the spirit man, and it held on until He brought you back. The part of you that would not turn loose was the spirit, my friend. You were in contact with the spirit. He would not turn loose.

The key is learning not to operate in the emotions, the highs and lows, but out of the part of you that would not give up.

At times, that part was beaten down until it was the bare flicker of a tiny flame barely escaping. You had collapsed in your intellect. You had already laid down and died. But that tiny flicker in the spirit said, "I am not having any part of this. No way. I am not giving up. Abba, help."

The Father, in the spirit, was bearing witness: "You are okay, child. I am your Father."

"But the other part of me does not feel like it."

"But I am your Father."

"But You do not know how bad it is."

"Yes, I am your Father."

"I want to give up."

"You cannot, because I am your Father."

"I cannot, because You are my Father. But I am going to the insane asylum."

"I will go with you, because I am your Father."

He would not give up until you came back.

The key is to walk in there on purpose and ignite that little flicker. Let me tell you a primary key to igniting it: praying in the Holy Ghost.

It does not matter how bad your emotions get or how badly you want to give up. When you begin praying in tongues, you bypass the soul altogether and operate out of that little boxed-in inner witness. The more He flows, the more that witness expands until He drives your emotions back where they are supposed to be: serving your spirit.

Glory to God.

Many times along the way, you hit impasses. They were strongholds, fortresses that said, "I am not giving up." You kept praying in tongues. How many noticed that you hit them and eliminated them?

Glory to God. I am having a time.

We are going to go on talking about this inner witness, feeding it, making it strong, and learning to operate out of it.

I do not care if you are the most talented person in the world. If your soul can suck you off into an operation of flesh, the devil can get out and just whip you.

"Yes, but they really use me singing and everything."

Yes, but five years from now you will still be the emotionally unstable mess you were when you entered the program.

So come on. Let us accept this leadership first. As we grow and get strong, we can go conquer the world, and there is not anything this side of hell that the devil can do about it.

So I am taking this territory. The devil says, "No, you are not."

I say, "Buddy, I can tell you do not have access to my spirit, because you would not say that if you knew what was going on."

Some of you, in emotional lusts and money, money, money, get sucked off into deals that cut your head off. But if you went and mortified that stuff, then He could lead you into business deals.

Glory.

Did anybody have as good a time as I did? Did you really hear with all your heart? Everybody stand up.